

Caring For Your LCD Monitor

□ LCD screens are delicate in comparison with the CRTs. Hence you need to be more careful in cleaning them. When wiping dust off, use a dry cloth first and then, if need be, wet a cloth, squeeze out excess water then use it. Do not press too hard on the screen as you may create 'stuck pixels'. Alcohol and Ammonia based cleaning agents are a strict no-no. Many monitors contain an anti glare coating which can easily get damaged when washing agents are applied on them.

□ LCDs use proprietary power supply. In case of the adaptor not functioning use the manufacturer recommended spare. If that is not available use only those adaptors which meet the voltage requirement exactly and a current ratings that is at least equal to rating of the original.

□ If you ever come across a stuck pixel (a dot whose colour does not change), try and gently rub on the spot where the pixel is stuck. Do not apply too much force as you will risk damaging adjacent pixels. If a couple of tries don't work, then just let go! Note that while stuck pixels may be corrected, dead pixels cannot be revived. A dead pixel appears black always while a stuck pixel stays on with a single colour.

A Buying Guide

In spite of the nice aesthetics, fatigue free viewing and power saving, LCD monitors have certain drawbacks and you must look out for specifications pertaining to the drawbacks before making an investment. They don't come cheap after all.

Response Time

This is the time taken by the monitor to change the colour and / or brightness of a pixel. It is measured in milliseconds and the values generally are 10, 12, 16 ms. Some LCD monitors offer a very quick response of 8 and even 6 ms. The lower this value is, the better the LCD is for viewing fast moving graphics such as games or action movies. With some entry level LCDs that offer a dismal 25ms response time, a ghosting effect becomes very noticeable. So look for LCDs with a response time of 10ms or lower.

Viewing Angle

Unlike CRTs, which can be viewed from pretty much any angle, images on LCDs will appear dull and even colour distorted when viewed from beyond a certain angle. Their best quality appears when viewed head on (perpendicular to the monitor). As you move sideways the display appears more and more distorted.

Viewing angle is the maximum angle at which you can see the display with no *noticeable* change in quality. Obviously, the greater this angle, the better the LCD is!

Native Resolution

LCDs have to be run at their native resolution which is the number of pixels that make up the display. Usually using a resolution that is lesser or greater will result in distorted display. Make sure that the native resolution of the LCD is something you are comfortable with.

Go for Goodies!

Speakers—Some CRT models of the bygone era (ok, say 8 years ago) tried bundling speakers in the monitor box. But not many of these 2-in-1 models were made owing to mutual interference between the speakers magnets and the high voltage, electromagnetic radiation of the monitor itself. With the coming of the LCD monitors there is no problem of interference, meaning it is much easier for manufacturers to bundle in speakers inside the monitor cabinet. These speakers don't need any extra power supply as they draw their power from the monitor's main DC supply.

USB Hub—How often do you have to try positions of yoga to hook up a digicam to the USB port at the back panel of your cabinet? If you are buying a LCD monitor, spend a little more and get one which has a USB hub. The monitor will have one cable that connects to the USB port on the back panel. On the monitor itself you will find USB ports (usually 4) to which you can connect USB devices. You not only get more USB ports, but also the ease of connecting the cables right at your desk. ■

kailas_shastri@thinkdigit.com

Room Lighting

Ambient lighting can make or mar the LCD experience. The best image quality on LCD monitors is attained under dim lighting. This is not practical if the room is being used by others; in such a case, it is best to have the lights to the *side* of the monitor. Bulbs meant for TV viewing are the best to use here—such bulbs have a reflective coating at the bottom so that there's no directed light, but the room appears well-illuminated. The downside is the higher power consumption of these bulbs, as they are tungsten based. In place of the bulbs,

you can use low-wattage CFL tubes, which can give you nearly as good lighting.

Lights behind the monitor (this applies even to CRTs) are to be avoided—they can distract your vision. They can also cause eye strain and mental fatigue, since you unconsciously try to avoid the more intense bulb or tube and concentrate on the monitor.

In the same way, lights behind you are also a strict no-no. They get reflected on your screen and not only spoil the viewing experience, but also cause eye strain.

Get the power of choice with Samsung SyncMaster TFT-LCD Monitors

The Samsung SyncMaster TFT-LCD Monitor Range

240T (51cm) | 214T (54.1cm) | 244T (51cm) | 710MP (43.1cm)
730MP (43.1cm) | 242MP (61.1cm) | 740N (43.1cm) | 740B (43.1cm)
940N (48.2cm) | 940T (48.2cm) | 770P (43.1cm)

MaxColor MaxSpeed MaxZone MaxTime ALL

Customer Support
1800-1234567
support.india@samsung.com



SAMSUNG